

The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Noble Heap of Flowers'

Āryapuṣpakūṭa nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 516 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་མ་ཉལོ་བརྒྱུས་པ་ཞེས་བརྒྱུན་གྱི་ཐུགས་

The dhāraṇī known in Sanskrit as the Āryapuṣpakūṭa nāma dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as "The Noble Heap of Flowers" is a dhāraṇī scripture belonging to the Kangyur, catalogued as Toh 516. As a dhāraṇī text, it presents a sacred formula of spiritual power set within a narrative frame in which the Buddha teaches at the great lake Anavatapta, in the palace of the nāga king Anavatapta, before a vast assembly of monks and highly advanced bodhisattvas. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a class of works that transmit mantra-based practices associated with protection, purification, and spiritual attainment. It was translated into Tibetan by the monk and great editor-translator Yeshé Dé in collaboration with the Indian scholar Dānaśīla, and was subsequently revised and finalized in accordance with the standardized Tibetan terminology established during the imperial period of translation.

Translated by the great editor-translator (lotsāwa), the monk Yeshé Dé, working together with Dānaśīla, and then revised and finalized in accordance with the new standardized terminology.

In the Indian language: Āryapuṣpakūṭa nāma dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The dhāraṇī called "The Noble Heap of Flowers."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at the great lake Anavatapta, in the palace of Anavatapta, king of the nāgas, together with a great Saṅgha of five hundred monks, and with a vast assembly of bodhisattvas who had gathered from various other world-realms. All of those bodhisattvas, complete in their thousand, had attained dhāraṇīs, had attained meditative absorption, were hindered by only one more birth, dwelt fully established on the ten grounds, had just been consecrated with the empowerment of a regent, had donned the great armor, and were likewise all utterly free of doubt regarding every quality of a buddha.

At that time the great bodhisattva (bodhisattva mahāsattva) known as Siṃhavijayin was present in that very assembly. Then the great bodhisattva Siṃhavijayin rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, turned toward the Blessed One and,

pressing his palms together in reverence, addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, how much merit would be generated by a son or daughter of good family who were to make offerings to a Tathāgata?"

When this was asked, the Blessed One replied to the great bodhisattva Siṃhavijayin with these words: "Siṃhavijayin, do not say it that way — asking how much merit would be generated by a son or daughter of good family who makes offerings to a Tathāgata. And why not? Because the Tathāgata is immeasurable in moral discipline, immeasurable in meditative absorption, immeasurable in wisdom, immeasurable in liberation, and immeasurable in the gnosis that sees liberation. Siṃhavijayin, because the Tathāgata, the arhat, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha, possesses an immeasurable accumulation of qualities, the karmic maturation of making offerings to him must likewise be understood as immeasurable.

"Siṃhavijayin, whether a Tathāgata is present in the world or has passed fully into nirvāṇa, all those who make offerings — every single one of them will pass fully into nirvāṇa by means of one of the three vehicles: the vehicle of the hearers (śrāvakas), or the vehicle of the solitary buddhas (pratyekabuddhas), or the Great Vehicle.

"Furthermore, Siṃhavijayin, whoever, upon seeing the Tathāgata, the arhat, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha, becomes open-hearted and, with a mind of faith, attends upon him with respect — honoring him with whatever has been obtained: robes, food, bedding, medicine for the sick, and all requisites and comforts — making images and performing worship, veneration, and acts of reverence; and whoever makes offerings to a stūpa containing a relic of a Tathāgata who has passed fully into nirvāṇa — even a relic no larger than a mustard seed — the karmic maturation of these two acts must be understood as equal. There is no distinction or difference between them.

"Siṃhavijayin, whatever householder bodhisattva makes offerings to hearers, to solitary buddhas, and to—"

— to the Tathāgatas, arhats, and perfectly and completely awakened buddhas offerings of a heap of precious substances equal in size to Mount Meru — yet a bodhisattva who has gone forth and made an offering of even a single kārṣāpaṇa coin, and having done so dedicates it entirely to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening: the former root of virtue does not approach even a hundredth part of the latter root of virtue, not a thousandth part, not a hundred-thousandth part, not any fraction, portion, count, share, reckoning,

computation, or comparison — it is beyond all analogy.

Siṃhavijayin, whoever serves a Tathāgata, arhat, and perfectly and completely awakened buddha for a year, or a hundred years, or a thousand years, honoring him with all comforts and requisites — and whoever, holding firmly to the awakening mind, offers even a few flowers to a stūpa of a Tathāgata who has passed fully into nirvāṇa, for the sake of making offerings to that Tathāgata; or scatters a double handful of water; or traces a dot of ointment; or arranges a bed of flowers; or presents ointment, incense, flowers, burnt offerings, garlands, the sound of musical instruments, an umbrella, a bell, a hanging ornament, a victory banner, a flag, a silk pennant, or a lamp — and having made these offerings, with a joyful mind takes a few steps in a dancing gait and says, "I pay homage to that Blessed One, the Buddha" — Siṃhavijayin, there is no basis whatsoever for such a person to fall into the lower realms or to fall back, whether for a single eon, a hundred eons, a thousand eons, or a hundred thousand eons. Have no doubt, no wavering, no uncertainty about this.

Siṃhavijayin, there is a dhāraṇī called Heaped Flowers. For the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many, out of love for the world, for the good, benefit, and happiness of the great multitude of gods and humans, it should be taught. Siṃhavijayin, whoever holds, retains, recites, takes to mind, masters fully, or teaches it extensively and correctly to others — that person will forever remember their past lives. They will not fall into the lower realms. They will attain leisure and freedom. They will never be parted from the Three Jewels. They will never be parted from the Tathāgatas. They will never be parted from the recollection of the buddhas. They will never be parted from bodhisattvas. They will never be parted from the awakening mind. Their sense faculties will never be deficient. They will never be born into a low lineage. They will come to possess a wealth of eloquence, various and profound. They will behold the blessed buddhas of the innumerable world-realms in all ten directions.

The dhāraṇī is as follows: tadyathā — dhāraṇī dhāraṇī muni-prabhāsvare siddhi caṇḍenāma-cini heri arogavati buddhamati dhari oṃ karete gagara-te tejovati pipula-buddhe dharma-avabhāse akṣayakalpe kalpavati amṛtakalpe hutāśane tejovati niryasaṃhīte tego-grāvātiṣṭhina-draye tiṣṭhina-draye bundhi svāhā.

Siṃhavijayin, whoever knows all the name, letters, and words of this dhāraṇī called Heaped Flowers and masters it fully — beginning from the eighth day of the waxing fortnight of the last month of spring, the first month of summer, and the last month of autumn, up through the fifteenth, let that person cultivate the recollection of the buddhas.

three times by day and three times by night, contemplating it thus, and with one-pointed mind taking the Tathāgatas to heart — if that person then makes offerings to the Blessed One with incense, flowers, lamps, and fragrant smoke, that person will behold, fifteen times, the Blessed One, the buddha, seated upon a lion throne at the heart of a lotus, and will teach the Dharma as well. That person will come to master dhāraṇī perfectly. That person will become endowed with mindfulness. That person will become endowed with intelligence. That person will become endowed with realization. That person will become endowed with discernment. Until final nirvāṇa is reached, that person will remember all past lives. That person will come to know perfectly all that is heard, all treatises, all crafts, and all activities. All meditative absorptions too will be purified from within that person's mind — with the exception of the Four Noble Truths of the noble ones. And why is that? It is because those phenomena belong to the category of the undefiled.

Having thus declared these words, the Blessed One addressed the bodhisattva, the great being Siṃhavijayin, along with those bodhisattvas, those monks, the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas —

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, suggesting the passage is incomplete as given. The translation follows accordingly.

The phrase rendered "becomes open-hearted" translates a construction meaning the mind becomes clear or unobstructed upon seeing the Tathāgata, indicating a spontaneous opening of devotion; some editions could support "whose mind is gladdened," but "open-hearted" captures the doctrinal nuance of receptivity and joy arising together.

Siṃhavijayin, the name of the bodhisattva, literally means "Lion's Play" or "Lion's Sport" in Sanskrit, corresponding to the Tibetan *seng ge rnam par rtse*; it is kept as a Sanskrit reconstruction throughout.

- The *kārṣāpaṇa* is a small copper coin of ancient India, used here to contrast maximally with the heap of precious substances as large as Mount Meru — the doctrinal point being that even the smallest offering dedicated to perfect awakening surpasses any offering, however vast, made without that dedication.

The three months named for the dhāraṇī practice — the last month of spring, the first month of summer, and the last month of autumn — correspond to the three traditional

"eighth-to-fifteenth" waxing-fortnight observance periods found in several Sanskrit sūtras; the specific calendar system is Indian lunar.

The dhāraṇī syllables are rendered as they appear in the Tibetan transliteration; the Sanskrit is not fully recoverable to standard form in all places, which is normal for dhāraṇī passages in canonical Tibetan translations.

- The phrase "behold the Blessed One fifteen times" reflects the Tibetan bco lnga mthong bar 'gyur, which likely refers to visionary encounters or contemplative visions on each of the fifteen days of practice specified in the preceding passage. The exclusion of the Four Noble Truths from purification via samādhī is doctrinally grounded: as undefiled phenomena, they are not objects that can be "purified" by meditative means in the ordinary sense, since they already belong to the domain of the transcendent. This is a standard Abhidharma distinction and is preserved faithfully here.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.